

JERIK CRUZ

positions	Harvard University , Kennedy School of Government (Start Sept. 2026) Postdoctoral Fellow, Reimagining the Economy Project & Harvard Center for International Development
education	Massachusetts Institute of Technology (Sept. 2020 - Sept. 2026) PhD in Political Science <i>Dissertation:</i> World Wide Webs: How Migrant Networks and Porous Bureaucracies Forged the Knowledge Economy in the Global South <i>Fields:</i> Political Economy, Quantitative Methods (<i>High Pass/Distinction, all general exams</i>) <i>Awards:</i> NSF/APSA Doctoral Dissertation Improvement Grant, MIT Presidential Fellowship Graduate Institute of International and Development Studies (Geneva, CHE) Master in Development Studies Ateneo de Manila University (Manila, PHL) A.B in Economics, Minor in Philosophy
research interests	Comparative & international political economy; bureaucracy; industrial policy; technology; development. Computational and historical methods. <i>Area focus:</i> Southeast Asia, North/Central America.
work in progress	“World Wide Webs: How Migrant Networks and Porous Bureaucracies Forged the Knowledge Economy in the Global South” (Job Market Paper) ★ 2026 <i>Best Paper in Science, Technology & Environmental Politics</i> , <i>American Political Science Association</i> ★ 2026 <i>Best Paper in Comparative Policy</i> , <i>American Political Science Association</i> “Bayesian inference and typological thinking: an integrated framework for typological & computational research” ★ 2026 <i>Emerging Methodologist</i> , <i>American Political Science Association QMMR Section</i> “From precarity to illiberalism: the political economy of democratic erosion in the Philippines” (with Rico La Viña) “Mapping the global landscape of industrial policy bureaucracies with large language models, 1989-2010” The US tariff data project: American trade politics from 1789-2023 (with In Song Kim) The digital developmental state (with Andrew Stokols) OpenAudit: advancing governance research with LLM-processed government audit reports (with Uriel Galace) ★ 2023 <i>MIT Prize for Open Data</i>
selected publications	with E. de la Cruz. 2023. “Platforming populism: the services transition, precarious urbanization, and digital platforms in the rise of illiberal populism in the Philippines.” <i>Cambridge Journal of Regions, Economy and Society</i> . Special Issue: <i>The Power of Platforms</i> 16(12): 269-288 with M. Montes. 2020. “The political economy of foreign investment and industrial development: the Philippines, Malaysia and Thailand in perspective.” <i>Journal of the Asia-Pacific Economy</i> 25(1): 16-39.
selected fellowships	APSA Qualitative and Multi-Method Research Section Emerging Methodologist 2026 Massachusetts Institute of Technology Social and Ethical Responsibilities of Computing Scholar 2025 Tagpuan Center, Ateneo de Manila University Fellow for Bridging Cultural Divides 2025 Institute for Humane Studies Junior Fellow 2024, 2025 Harvard Kennedy School Program on Science, Technology, and Society Predoctoral Fellow 2023

	Mercatus Center, George Mason University Adam Smith Fellow	2023
	Southeast Asia Research Group Pre-Dissertation Fellowship	2022
	Ronald Coase Institute Ronald Coase Institute Fellowship	2020
selected grants and awards	APSA Public Policy Section Best Comparative Policy Paper Award	2026
	APSA Science, Technology, & Environmental Politics Section Paul Sabatier Best Paper Award	2026
	Institute for Human Studies Humane Studies Fellowship (Total: \$5,000)	2026
	Microsoft AI Economy Institute 2nd Global Research Call (with A. Stokols, H. Vo) (Total: \$75,000)	2025
	NSF/APSA Doctoral Dissertation Improvement Grant Award (Total: \$15,400)	2024
	MIT GOV/LAB MIT GOV/LAB Seed Grant (Total: \$10,000)	2022, 2024
	MIT Center for International Studies Summer Study Research Grant (Total: \$7,600)	2023, 2024
	MIT School of Science and MIT Libraries MIT Open Data Prize	2023
	Ateneo de Manila University Research Council Conglomerates and Inclusive Growth (\$65,000)	2018
	International Development Research Centre Economics of Tobacco Control Initiative (\$200,000)	2018
selected presentations	International Political Economy Society	2026 (Scheduled)
	American Political Science Association	2023, 2025, 2026
	Midwest Political Science Association, IL	2023, 2025, 2026
	El Colegio de México, Mexico City	2026
	University of Oxford, Saïd Business School Research Seminar	2025
	Qualitative Bayesian Reasoning Network Workshop (Online)	2023, 2025
	Harvard-MIT-Boston University Cambridge Chinese Politics Research Workshop, MA	2024
	<i>Massachusetts Institute of Technology</i>	
selected teaching	Political Science Laboratory: Regression and Causal Inference, Instructor (UG)	Spring 2025
	Quantitative Methods I: Regression Foundations, Teaching Assistant (G)	Fall 2023
	<i>Ateneo de Manila University</i>	
	International Political Economy, Instructor (UG/G)	Spring 2020
	Courses in Economics and Development Economics, Instructor (UG)	2017-2019
leadership and service	Co-Founder and Organizer, MIT Computational Social Science Graduate Student Workshop	2025
	Committee for the MIT Open Data Prize, MIT Open Data Prize	2024, 2025
	Board Member and Communications Chair, 70 Amherst Graduate House Government	2023-2025
	Mentor, MIT Political Science Graduate Mentorship Program	2022-2023, 2024-2025
	<i>Reviewer: Perspective on Politics, Competition & Change, Journal of Contemporary Asia</i>	
selected policy work	Open Society Foundations	New York, USA
	Consultant, Asia-Pacific Program	2023
	The Asia Foundation	Manila, PHL
	Lead Technical Advisor, Coalitions for Change Program	2023
	United Nations Development Program	Manila, PHL
	Political Scientist Consultant, Pintig Lab and COVID-19 FASSSTER project	2020-2022

selected
policy
publications

J. Cruz and E. La Vina. 2024. “The services transition, platform capitalism, and the path to illiberal populism: insights from the Philippines” in *Understanding the drivers of political polarization and social exclusion in Southeast Asia*. New York: Open Society Foundations

J. Cruz and E. La Vina. 2022. “From Dependency to Autonomy: Local Governance, Fiscal Capacity, and the Outlook for Philippine Local Governments in the post-COVID era,” in *Decentralization, Digitalization, and Development: Strengthening Local Governance for Recovery, Resilience, and the Sustainable Development Goals*. Manila: United Nations Development Program (lead flagship report chapter)

A. Ang, J. Cruz, and N. Custodio. 2019. “The impact of trade on employment in the Philippines: a country report” Country Technical Report. Manila: International Labour Organization.

selected
professional
experience

Action for Economic Reforms	Manila, PHL
Fellow, Industrial Policy Team	2018-Present
Advocacy Strategist, Tax Reform Team	2012-2014
Ateneo de Manila University	Manila, PHL
Lecturer, Department of Economics	2017-2020
Economist (Business & Government Program), Ateneo School of Government	2017-2019
United Nations Research Institute for Social Development	Geneva, CHE
Research Assistant	2015

selected
additional
training

Systems Science for Social Impact, WashU in St. Louis	2021 (Network Analysis), 2025 (ABM)
Institute for Qualitative and Multi-Method Research, Syracuse University	2024
Bayesian Reasoning for Qualitative Social Science, London School of Economics	2022
Asia Institute for Political Economy, University of Hong Kong and Georgetown University	2009

computing

R, STATA, Python, ~~TeX~~ LaTeX, HTML, Markdown, GitHub, Qualtrics, MS Office

languages

English (Native), Tagalog (Native), French (Intermediate), Spanish (Intermediate), Mandarin (Beginner)

refences

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